

ENGLISH WITH DEEDAR

BOOK 2

DUMMY / IMPERSONAL PRONOUNS

DUMMY PRONOUN No. 1 — THERE

1. What is a Dummy Pronoun?

A **dummy pronoun** is a word used in a sentence when the real subject is unknown, unimportant, or placed later in the sentence. The word **there** can be used as a dummy pronoun.

There is → singular **There are** → plural

2. THERE AS A DUMMY PRONOUN

We use **there** when we introduce or point out the existence or presence of someone or something.

There is + singular noun

There is a cat.

There is a book on the table.

There is a teacher in the classroom.

There is an old man under the tree.

There is a rat at the corner of the cupboard.

There are + plural noun

There are two sisters before us.

There are thousands of ants around the tree.

There are many books on the table.

There are five students in the classroom.

There are some flowers in the garden.

3. THE EASY TRICK

There is when the noun is singular: There is a cat under the table.

There are when the noun is plural: There are two cats under the table.

4. THE MAIN IDEA

There is / There are = something or someone exists or is present somewhere.

There is milk in the jug.

There is a rat at the corner of the cupboard.

There are two sisters before us.

There are thousands of ants around the tree.

5. THERE IS/ARE vs. HAS/HAVE

We can sometimes express the same idea in two different structures.

THERE IS / THERE ARE	HAS / HAVE
There is a fan in the class.	The class has a fan.
There are stars in the sky.	The sky has stars.

THERE IS / THERE ARE	HAS / HAVE
There are two SIMs in the mobile.	The mobile has two SIMs.
There is water in the bottle.	The bottle has water.
There are books on the table.	The table has books.

DUMMY PRONOUN No. 2 — IT

6. What is Dummy “IT”?

The word **it** can be used as a dummy pronoun when it does not refer to a particular thing or object.

7. DUMMY IT FOR WEATHER

It is hot. • It is cold. • It is cloudy. • It is windy. • It is sunny. • It is raining. • It is drizzling.

8. DUMMY IT FOR TIME

It is five o'clock. • It is half past six. • It is noon. • It is midnight. • It is late.

9. DUMMY IT FOR DAYS AND DATES

It is Monday. • It is Sunday today. • It is August 9. • It is my birthday today.

10. DUMMY IT FOR DISTANCE

It is five kilometres from here to the school. • It is a long way from here.

11. DUMMY IT FOR GENERAL CONDITIONS

It is difficult. • It is easy. • It is important. • It is necessary. • It is possible. • It is dangerous.

12. REAL IT vs. DUMMY IT

Real it: I have a book. It is interesting. → *it = the book*

Dummy it: It is raining. → *it does not refer to a particular thing*

13. THERE vs. IT

There introduces existence/presence: There is a fan in the classroom. There are stars in the sky.

It is used for weather, time, day/date, distance, and general conditions: It is hot. It is five o'clock. It is Monday. It is difficult.

14. THERE — DUMMY PRONOUN OR ADVERB?

The word **there** can also be an **adverb of place**.

Dummy there: There is a cat. → *there introduces the cat; it does not mean a particular place.*

Adverb there: A cat is there. → *there tells us where the cat is; it means approximately “in that place.”*

15. THE BEST COMPARISON

There is a cat. → there = dummy pronoun

The cat is there. → there = adverb of place

There are stars in the sky. → there = dummy pronoun

The stars are there. → there = adverb of place

16. THERE CAN APPEAR IN DIFFERENT POSITIONS

Beginning: **There is a fan in the class.**

End: **The fan is there.**

Middle: **An old man is sitting there under the tree.**

17. THERE IS/ARE vs. IS/ARE + THERE

There is a cat. → there = dummy pronoun; **a cat** = real subject.

A cat is there. → **a cat** = subject; there = adverb of place.

18. THREE USES TO REMEMBER

- ① **Dummy pronoun:** There is a fan in the class.
- ② **Adverb of place:** The fan is there.
- ③ **Fixed expressions:** There you are! There it is! There they go!

MASTER TRICK

There + is/are/was/were + noun → usually dummy there.

Subject + is/are/was/were + there → there = adverb of place.

19. PRACTICE — THERE OR IT

1. _____ is a fan in the classroom.
2. _____ is raining.
3. _____ are stars in the sky.
4. _____ is very hot today.
5. _____ is five o'clock.
6. _____ is a book on the table.
7. _____ is Monday.
8. _____ are two SIMs in the mobile.
9. _____ is difficult to learn English without practice.
10. _____ is five kilometres from here to the school.

ANSWERS

1. There 2. It 3. There 4. It 5. It 6. There 7. It 8. There 9. It 10. It

20. FINAL PRACTICE

Write **5 sentences with There is**, **5 with There are**, **5 with dummy It**, and **5 with there as an adverb of place**.